PRINCE MOHAMMAD BIN FAHD UNIVERSITY

Admissions Office

Admissions Office Webpages

Revisit Review and Recommendations

Executive report on the published content of pmu.edu.sa/admission/admission and its directly linked pages

Document control	
Prepared for	Mr. Radhi H. Alkhaldi
Prepared by	Nader Alfarhan, Student Affairs
Reference	Email thread "comments on Admission pages" (October 2025 – September 2026)
Content reviewed as of	10 October 2026 (key facts re-checked 11 October 2026)
Version / status	1.0 – For review and decision
Classification	Internal

1. Executive Summary

At your request, the Admissions Office webpages were revisited to review their published content and provide feedback, continuing the comments exchanged in the thread "comments on Admission pages". The review covered the Admissions Office page, all 37 pages linked directly from it and the application portal. Every content line was read and checked against the other pages and the University's own fee tables.

39	1,248	71	211	10
Pages reviewed	Content lines audited	Key findings	Detailed page notes	Decisions required

Key messages

- **Applicants cannot currently see a valid admission cycle.** The only admission calendar covers Fall 2026, all its dates have passed, and the application portal shows "No events are currently published".
- **Several critical values conflict between pages.** These include application fees (SAR 500 excl. VAT vs SAR 950 incl. VAT; Medicine SAR 1,000 vs SAR 1,150), entry tests (SAT II is still required for international CS/Engineering applicants) and English requirements for graduate programmes.
- **Most amendments requested in the thread are not yet live.** B.S. Chemical Engineering has been added; the weighted minimums, fee changes, SAT II removal, Aptis fee and retirement of the old CS/Engineering page are not yet reflected.
- **The root cause is structural rather than editorial.** The same rule or fee is maintained on several pages without a single approved source, owner or effective date, so corrections do not propagate.
- **37 of the 71 key findings can be corrected directly** (wording, links, accessibility, page titles); 34 depend on ten owner decisions, listed in Section 7.

Overall status

NOT READY FOR CLOSURE. Closure requires the ten decisions, the corresponding page corrections and a read-back check of the live pages.

2. Background and Mandate

The thread "comments on Admission pages" (October 2025 – September 2026) recorded comments and requested amendments to the Admissions webpages, including weighted minimum scores, fees, SAT II requirements, the Aptis fee, new programmes and the retirement of older pages. Mr. Radhi requested a revisit of the Admissions Office page to review it carefully and provide feedback. This report responds to that request and updates the status of the earlier comments against what is currently published.

3. Scope and Methodology

Element	Approach
Scope	Admissions Office page (Level 0), the 37 pages linked from its content (Level 1), the application portal, and three official fee pages used to verify amounts (Level 2). Site-wide header, footer and menus were excluded.
Reading	Every page was read line by line in a mobile browser view (390 px), including tables and content inside tabs (257 lines). The /apply page was read from its source (136 lines) because it redirects visitors immediately.
Checks per line	Applicant segment, term or date, consistency with other pages and with the official fee tables, spelling and wording, and a review status.
Independent verification	An earlier set of 214 detailed page notes was re-verified one by one against the captured pages: 169 confirmed, 42 partly confirmed, 3 not verifiable, none rejected.
Re-check	The Priority 1 facts were re-checked on the live site on 11 October 2026; all remained unchanged.
Evidence standard	A finding is recorded only with verbatim text from the published page. Requests in the thread are treated as requests, not as approved policy.

Element	Approach
Boundaries	Read-only: no page, form or payment was changed or submitted. The Contact Us staff list was not copied (personal names).

4. Results by Area

Area	P1	P2	P3	Total	Needs decision
Fees & VAT	3	2	0	5	3
Eligibility & admission criteria	2	10	4	16	7
Admission cycle, calendar & application route	2	4	3	9	5
Graduate programmes & catalogue	1	10	3	14	10
English language tests	0	5	1	6	5
Contact & privacy	0	2	1	3	2
Wording, accessibility & web quality	0	4	14	18	2
Total	8	37	26	71	34

Priority definitions: P1 – affects eligibility, fees or the application route; P2 – inconsistency or missing information; P3 – wording, accessibility or housekeeping. Ten of the key findings concern legacy pages that are still online but no longer linked from the Admissions page.

Priority 1 findings

#	Topic	What the published pages show	Impact
1	**International CS/Engineering criteria**	"Computer Science & Engineering Majors: Secondary School 40% / SAT I 30% / SAT II 30%". SAT Subject Tests were discontinued in 2021.	Applicants are asked for a test they cannot take.
2	**International transfer / visiting fee**	"SAR 500 (excl. VAT)" on the international page; "SAR 950 (incl. VAT)" on the transfer and visiting pages and the official fees page.	Different amounts for the same service; billing disputes.
3	**Medicine application fee**	"SAR 1000 (incl. VAT)" on the admission page; "SAR 1,150 (VAT inclusive)" on the medical fees page.	Applicants may pay the wrong amount.
4	**Admission calendar**	Fall 2026-2027 only; last application date 2026-06-24; orientation "TBA"; portal: "No events are currently published".	No visible next intake for prospective applicants.
5	**EMGMS page**	Refers to "UA Center for English as Second Language (CESL)"; TOEFL 79 / IELTS 7 unlike all other pages; no application link.	Reputational risk; unclear requirements.
6	**Non-Saudi applicants**	Calendar: "Apply online through Study in Saudi platform … Closed" with no date; the international page gives no route or deadline.	Non-Saudi applicants cannot tell how or when to apply.

5. Status of Previously Requested Amendments

Request in the thread	Live status (re-checked 11 Oct 2026)	Status
B.S. Chemical Engineering	Listed on Degrees & Programs	**Implemented**
Minimum weighted score 74% (CS/Eng) / 72% (others)	Not shown on visible pages; published minima compute to 73% / 72%	**Decision needed**
International / transfer / visitor fee SAR 950	International page still SAR 500 (excl. VAT)	**Partial**
Remove SAT II (CS & Engineering)	International page still shows SAT II 30%	**Not implemented**
Aptis re-test fee SAR 950	Fees page SAR 575; Aptis page shows no fee	**Not implemented**
Retire old CS/Engineering page and old guide	CS/Engineering page still live; guide not verifiable	**Not implemented**
Graphic Design – female only	Degrees & Programs shows Male and Female	**Not implemented**
Admission data-flow (February 2026 draft)	Not published	**Draft**

6. Root Causes

The findings point to a small number of underlying causes. Correcting individual sentences without addressing them is likely to reproduce the same issues in the next cycle.

Cause	Evidence	Basis
No single approved source for admission values	The same fee, test or threshold appears on several pages with different values (e.g. SAR 500/950; IELTS 6.0/6.5 for MIBL).	Observed
No recorded owner, approver or effective date	Pages carry no "last updated" or effective-intake information; requests in the thread have no recorded approval or implementation date.	Observed
No seasonal update routine	The calendar still shows Fall 2026; orientation "TBA"; home-page items dated 2023–2028.	Observed
Legacy pages not retired	Older admission pages with outdated rules remain online and searchable.	Observed
Content placed where applicants cannot see it	Bachelor's minimums appear only in /apply, which redirects instantly; 257 lines sit in hidden tabs.	Observed
Copied or template content not reviewed	EMGMS text from another institution; repeated misspelling "ADMISSSIONS" across six pages.	Inferred

7. Decisions Required

The following decisions are required before the related wording can be corrected. Recommendations are subject to the owners' approval; no value should be published as policy without written confirmation.

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Owner
D-01	**Next intake and application route by applicant type**	Publish (b) immediately, then (a) once dates are approved, with one route per applicant type (Saudi, non-Saudi, transfer, visiting, graduate).	Admissions + Web + IT
D-02	**Fee and VAT matrix**	Finance confirms one table (amount, VAT basis, applicant type, effective intake); every admission page then cites that table.	Finance + Admissions + PREP
D-03	**Minimum weighted scores**	Decide (a) or (b) and record the effective intake; ensure the published component minima are consistent with the decision.	Admissions policy owner
D-04	**Undergraduate criteria for international and specialised majors**	Approve (a)–(c) together so that the international, SAT, CS & Engineering and /apply pages state the same rule.	Admissions + Colleges
D-05	**Graduate English requirements and EMGMS page**	Remove the external text immediately; publish approved EMGMS requirements and route, and one MIBL threshold.	Graduate Studies + College of Engineering
D-06	**English test equivalence**	Approve one table for all pages, including the TOEFL 1–6 scale.	Admissions + Testing Center
D-07	**Medicine selection formula**	College of Medicine confirms the formula, minima and language requirement.	College of Medicine + Admissions
D-08	**Graduate catalogue and programme names**	Publish one graduate catalogue used by admission, fee and programme pages.	Graduate Studies + Academic Affairs
D-09	**Admissions contact and privacy notice**	Approve both; publish an official admissions email/phone and a reviewed notice.	Admissions + Compliance
D-10	**Legacy pages**	Redirect or unpublish after Admissions confirms each page.	Admissions + Web

8. Recommendations and Implementation Roadmap

Recommendations

1. **Publish an interim admission-cycle notice now** and one application route per applicant type (Decision D-01).
2. **Make the official fee table the only fee reference** and link every admission page to it (D-02).

3. **Correct the 37 findings that need no decision** (wording, titles, links, accessibility, Arabic spelling) as a first batch.
4. **Remove the external text from the EMGMS page immediately** and publish approved requirements (D-05).
5. **Create a single admissions source of truth** in which every critical value has an owner, approver, effective intake and last-reviewed date.
6. **Introduce a pre-cycle content review** before each intake, with a read-back check of the live pages after every change.
7. **Restructure the Admissions page around applicant type** (Saudi, non-Saudi, transfer, visiting, graduate, Medicine), showing status, requirements, fees, deadline and route.

Roadmap (durations start from the relevant approval)

Phase	Work	Dependency	Indicative effort
0 – Decide	Owners decide D-01 to D-10 and confirm values in writing.	Leadership direction	Owner-dependent
1 – Quick fixes	Interim cycle notice; remove EMGMS external text; correct wording, titles, links and Arabic spelling (37 direct findings).	None for direct fixes	Short (days)
2 – Decided corrections	Apply approved fees, thresholds, tests, graduate requirements and contact/privacy changes (34 findings).	Phase 0 decisions	Short to medium
3 – Structural	Single source of truth, applicant-type entry page, retirement of legacy pages, pre-cycle review routine.	Web/IT capacity	Medium

9. Acceptance and Closure Criteria

An item is closed only when all of the following are evidenced:

- The approved value is recorded with its owner, approver and effective intake.
- The live page has been updated and re-read after publication (Arabic and English, mobile and desktop).
- Related pages, links and the application portal show the same value.
- The register entry is updated with the date and evidence of the read-back check.

10. Limitations

- The desktop view could not be tested because automated desktop access was blocked; mobile view was used throughout.
- Content that appears only after interaction (pop-ups) and the downloadable PDF guides were not fully reviewed.
- TOEFL/IELTS equivalences refer to the published ETS tables; setting thresholds remains the owners' decision.
- This is a content review; it did not test the application or payment workflows.

Appendix A – Attachments

No.	File	Content
02	Admission Pages Comments Register (xlsx)	Summary; A. 71 key findings with area, evidence, proposed change and decision link; B. 211 page-by-page notes; C. ten decisions with options and recommendations; D. status of earlier requests.
03	Published Content Line-by-Line Ledger (xlsx)	Every published line of each page with its review status and cross-reference (for reference).

Appendix B – Pages Reviewed

ID	Page	ID	Page
P00	Admissions Office	P20	Admissions to the EMGMS Program
P01	University home page	P21	Admissions to the MIBL
P02	Study @ PMU	P22	Post Graduate Fees
P03	Future Students – Overview	P23	Graduate Contact Info
P04	Degrees & Programs	P24	Undergraduate Admissions (landing page)
P05	Admissions Calendar	P25	Admission to the College of Medicine
P06	Contact Us (staff list – not copied)	P26	Admissions to the Preparatory Program
P07	Admission Query	P27	Direct Admissions from Secondary School
P08	Apply Now	P28	Admissions from Other Universities
P09	International Students without Saudi Residence	P29	Visiting Students
P10	Graduate Programs (landing page)	P30	Admissions from the Preparatory Program
P11	Admissions to the PhD in Mechanical Engineering Program	P31	Computer Science and Engineering Majors Admission Requirements
P12	Admissions to the PhD in Business Administration Program	P32	Undergraduate Fees
P13	Admissions to the EMBA Program	P33	English Tests – Overview
P14	Admissions to the MBA Program	P34	Aptis
P15	Admissions to the MSHD Program	P35	IELTS
P16	Admissions to the MSME Program	P36	TOEFL
P17	Admissions to the MSEE Program	P37	Scholastic Aptitude Test (SAT)
P18	Admissions to the MSCE Program	P38	Application portal welcome
P19	Admissions to the MSID Program		